It was two men who would provide anxiety for the Silla rulers. Gyeon Hwon or Kyon Hwon was a leader of the peasants. He reestablished the old Baekje kingdom to the south in 892 CE. This state is typically called the Later Baekje. At the same time, the Buddhist monk Gung Ye or Kungye founded another Goguryeo kingdom to the north in 901 CE, which is referred to as the Later Goguryeo. These establishments plunged Korea back into civil war, and the situation became very similar to how it was during the Three Kingdoms Period.

Historians call this era the Later Three Kingdoms period. In 927 CE, Kyon Hwon struck Kumsong with a brutal clash. Meanwhile, Gung Ye was assassinated by one of his own people because his followers had begun to hate his tyrannical methods. Wang Geon succeeded him in 918 CE and immediately attacked Later Baekje, which was suffering from internal fighting. He then turned to Silla with hordes of cavalry and a vast array of archers. Such was his might that the final king of Silla Kyongsun was forced to surrender in 935 CE. Wang Geon emerged as the final victor and was able to reunite his country under the new Goryeo Dynasty.